

[KAI[FRAME] · FTM MASC BUILD PROTOCOL · PHASE 01]

FOUNDATION SPLIT.

MONTHS 0-6 · 4 DAYS/WEEK · UNDER 45 MINS

STABILITY + CONTROL · MOVEMENT PATTERNS · BASELINE STRENGTH

4

days / week

<45

mins / session

0-6

months

0

gatekeeping

[PHASE 01 · FROM KAI]

DON'T SKIP THIS.

This is your "learn your body" era. Don't skip it because it looks easy — it's not. You're building the movement patterns, stability, and baseline strength that every future gain runs on. 4 days a week, under 45 mins. Upper/lower split. Get familiar with failure.

[KAI · DIRECT]

"Movement quality over weight. Always. I don't care if the guy next to you is squatting twice what you are. You're learning patterns. Get them right now or pay for it later with an injury. One bad movement pattern repeated 10,000 times = one injury that sets you back six months. Do it right."

— kai · kai[frame]

[KNOW THE VOCAB FIRST]

GLOSSARY.

Learn these before you touch the workouts.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Rep	One complete motion. 8 reps = 8 full movements.
Set	3x8 = do 8 reps, rest, repeat 3 times total.
RPE	Rate of Perceived Exertion. 8 = 2 reps left. 9 = 1 left. Aim for 8-9 most sets.
RIR	Reps In Reserve. "2 RIR" = you could do 2 more. Stay at 1-2 RIR most sets.
Tempo	"2-1-2" = 2s lowering, 1s pause, 2s lifting. Slow = more gains.
Eccentric	The lowering phase. Where gains actually happen. Never rush this.
Concentric	The lifting phase — muscle shortens.
Deload	A lighter week every 4-8 weeks. Not weakness — it prevents burnout.
TDEE	Total Daily Energy Expenditure. Your daily calorie burn. Nutrition math starts here.

[PHASE 01 · MONTHS 0-6 · THE WORKOUTS]

THE PROGRAM.

Upper/lower split · 4 days/week · under 45 mins · movement quality over weight. Two lower body days, two upper body days. One stability-focused, one strength-focused.

DAY 1 — LOWER A (stability focus)

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Lunges	4 × 10/leg	2-1-2	Drive UP not forward. Feel the glute contract at top.
Hip Thrusts	3 × 15	2-0-3	Slow and controlled. Squeeze at the top for a full second.
Calf Raises	4 × 12	1-0-3	Fast up, SLOW down. Full stretch at the bottom.

DAY 2 — UPPER A (stability focus)

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Bicep Curls	3 × 8	3-1-2	Full extension at bottom. Don't swing.
Tricep Extensions	3 × 8	3-1-2	Lock elbows. Only forearms move.
Push-Ups	4 × 12	2-0-2	Incline if needed. Full ROM or don't count it.
Knee Tucks	3 × 15	1-1-3	Slow the eccentric. Feel the abs stretching.

DAY 3 — LOWER B (strength focus)

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Squats	4 × 6	2-1-2	Heavier day. Test your limits. Depth matters.
Hip Thrusts	3 × 6	2-0-3	Load it up compared to Day 1.
Hamstring Curls	4 × 10-12	2-1-3	Slow eccentric is the whole point here.
Leg Abductions	3 × 12-15	1-1-1	Cable or machine. Control the movement.

DAY 4 — UPPER B (strength focus)

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Low Rows	4 × 8-10	1-0-2	Squeeze shoulder blades. Row to your stomach.
Bench Press	2 × 12-15	2-1-2	Learn the bar path. Chest to bar, full lockout.
Assisted Pull-Ups	4 × 8-10	2-0-2	Use machine or bands. Full hang at bottom.
Knee Tucks	3 × 15	1-1-3	Same as Day 2. Feel the stretch.

[PROGRESSION · HOW TO KEEP GETTING STRONGER]

THE ONLY RULES.

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
Hit top of rep range?	Add 5lb next session. Always try weight first.
Can't add weight?	Add 1-2 reps per set. Hold 1-2 sessions then retry weight.
Can't add reps either?	Add one set for 2-4 weeks, then retry weight increase.
Going to failure every set?	Stop 1-2 reps short on most sets. Final set only for true failure.
Rest between sets?	Big muscles (legs, chest, back): 2-2.5 min. Small (arms): 1.5 min.
Feeling run down?	Take a deload. Drop to 60% volume for one full week. Not optional.

[WHAT COMES NEXT]

READY FOR MORE?

Complete all 6 months of the Foundation Split before moving on. When you're ready, the next two phases are below.

[PHASE 02 • MONTHS 6-12]

Frame Build.

Lats, shoulders, triceps. The V-taper holy trinity. Progressive overload starts here — track every session.

mascbuilder.com/frame-build

[PHASE 03 • MONTHS 12-24]

Full Bodybuilding Protocol.

5 days, heavier compounds, real mass. This is where your body actually starts to look different in the mirror.

mascbuilder.com/bodybuilding

[NEWSLETTER DROPS • SUBSCRIBERS ONLY]

WHAT DROPS NEXT.

You're on the list. Here's what's coming — newsletter subscribers only. No spam. No upsells. Just the program extensions.

[COMING SOON]

DIY HRT: WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

Self-administered HRT — pharmacology, sourcing landscape, dosing protocols, and harm reduction. No judgment. Just information.

[COMING SOON]

ADVANCED TRAINING: PERIODIZATION FOR FTM BODIES

Block periodization, peaking cycles, deload programming, and specialization phases for when you've outgrown beginner programming.

[COMING SOON]

CONFIDENCE + SOCIAL PASSING: THE REAL STUFF

Body language, vocal training, gendered spaces, building social confidence as a transmasculine person. The guide nobody wrote for us.

[COMING SOON]

FTM GROOMING: THE ACTUAL GUIDE

Beard care from day one on T, skincare for changing skin texture, haircuts for your face shape, and the grooming basics nobody taught us.

[COMING SOON]

SUPPLEMENTS: WHAT ACTUALLY WORKS

The supplement industry is a \$50 billion scam with three things worth buying. What the research says, what's placebo, and why everything else is just expensive pee.

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[KAI[FRAME] · FTM MASC BUILD PROTOCOL · FOUNDATION SPLIT · FREE · ALWAYS]

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